Letters continued from page 30

I've been using my 384K unit for one month and it's turned my single density Osborne 1 into a totally new machine.

Look here, it takes six seconds to go from the editing no file menu in WordStar to the dot prompt in dBASE II. Before I had Drive C: I had to boot up a new disk every time I wanted to edit a program. That was minutes waiting while the Osborne booted up different files. Now all I have to do is boot WordStar and then test the program with the R option. You run the program and then exit directly to WordStar. To step back and forth is now easy instead of a hassle.

Now all I have to do is boot the disks and run with it. I don't have to be constantly making disk accesses. I had to shell out $250 to Xerox for an exchange disk drive two months ago. Now my disk drives get 90% less wear and I do 90% more work.

Martin Kilgore
South Pasadena, CA

Krantz Responds: Drive C Review Stands

Your revived *Portable Companion* is certainly a source of surprises, at least to me. Your April/May issue reprinted my review of Drive C:, which I had nearly forgotten about. Your June/July issue's letters contained three attacks on the review.

One of the advantages to writing for a user group newsletter is that one knows the degree to which the reader will "read between the lines." In the case of TCOG, the readers take the material at face value, which is the way I write.

I find it interesting that both of the readers who responded are doing precisely what I said the unit would be good at — disk intensive operations for large parts of the day. This is "grossly inaccurate"?

We have passed the Drive C: around among many of the TCOG members, and it's not very hard to persuade an average user to give up the unit for the next person. I personally lost interest when Drive C: passed out Q&A flyers comparing Drive C: to CO-POWER-88. From that flyer you'd have thought the CO-POWER was the biggest rip-off of all time. It would have been just as useful for Zilog to compare the Z-80 chip to WordStar, or for a lamp manufacturer to beat up on a microwave oven because the oven light was hard to use as a reading lamp. Personally, I won't buy items marketed in that fashion.

I still stand by what I wrote — Drive C: is not a good buy for the average user.

Donald G. Krantz
Minneapolis, MN

Viva Archaic!

While I am relatively new to the use of personal computers in business (two years this December), I fully agree with your editorial regarding our "archaic" operating system. It will be a long time before any of the 16-bit systems achieve the level of support that CP/M enjoys. And if IBM proceeds with their plan for a proprietary operating system, such support may never materialize. OCC's reentry into the market is a significant achievement, and the Vixen is an impressive, affordable CP/M-based PC. I truly hope that our fickle marketplace gives it the attention that it deserves.

David W. Aukamp
Dunedin, FL

Faster? Better?

Just received the Nov/Dec issue of *The Portable Companion* and was interested in the article on speeding up WordStar by William D Esteb ("Faster Than a Shooting WordStar", p. 64).

I am sick of waiting for the garbage to parade past, like most WS users, so I jumped at the chance to do something about it. The change was simple to implement and the article easy to understand, and it took less than a minute to make the changes.

Unfortunately, after a successful first bootup, the screen went bonkers when I copied some files to another disk and tried to re-enter WordStar. I played around with a few things, trying to understand what was happening, and came to the conclusion that if NSWEEP is used to move the files, something happens to the WS.COM file and it can't be used again. I don't know enough about what's happening to do a fix, but I like the changed WordStar and can't do without NSWEEP. What do I do now? Mr. Esteb, is there a solution to this?

Ron Brown
Delhi, NY

I was somewhat dismayed with "Faster than a Shooting WordStar" by William D Esteb (Nov/Dec issue, p. 64). I think that it was well written for a novice such as me; it went step by step and was beautifully illustrated with expected displays. He forgot at least one thing though, and that was an "impact statement." He failed to tell me what I would have to give up if I changed all the suggested memory addresses to 01.

The initial messages whizzed by — good, that's what I wanted. But I found that WordStar no longer waited for my second command character when I was in the Help Level 2. If I wanted ^QC to go to the end of a file, WordStar would immediately display the help menu before I moved my finger to the C after typing the ^Q.

I find that using the Help Level 2 is more desirable to me than saving time at the beginning of a writing session. So, I needed to either return all the addresses to the original values or change one of the addresses. But, I had no idea which memory address affected the Help Level 2. After experimenting, I found that memory address 02D1H (WordStar 2.26) and memory address 02B1H (WordStar 3.30) were ones I was after. I returned them to their original state and left the other addresses as 01.

Carl T. Webster
Des Moines, IA

MBASIC to WordStar

The article "Print By Numbers" in

Continued on page 56